AIIB or the NDB into crony banks for the BRICS' vested interests. China, thus, seeks legitimacy through imposing effective market discipline on these new banks, to the extent possible.[79] In the case of RMB internationalization as well, Chinese efforts toward both domestic and international financial reforms should be seen as legitimate to convince market actors to use and hold RMB.

Meet a Diverse Array of Domestic Expectations

The fifth and final source of motivations to cooperate within the BRICS framework derives from China's domestic political concerns. Collective financial statecraft caters to three principal domestic constituencies, each of which demands a similar foreign economic policy stance, although for substantially different reasons. The first group of domestic constituents are the rationalists and pragmatists and those expecting the CCP to protect the value of China's external investments, as well as to offer increased welfare to the general public, as promised by President Xi in the form of "great rejuvenation of the Chinese nation" under the slogan "the Chinese Dream."[80] As an autocratic and developmental state with limited democratic instruments of accountability and legitimacy, the CCP has long relied on so-called performance legitimacy for its popular support.[81] As China becomes a major global economic actor and its domestic development becomes increasingly tied to events outside its borders, "it makes no sense to stand on the sidelines and let other powers remain the main arbiters of global affairs."[82] Hence, China's political leaders deliberately include components of China's diplomatic and foreign policy in their articulation of the "Chinese Dream."[83] Even prior to Xi, China's policy priority always lay with domestic economic development, and opening up and taking an active role in global management and regional cooperation has been understood as contributing to this goal.[84] Given the Chinese economy's global reach, cooperation and coordination with the BRICS can help the Chinese government accomplish its performance goals.

The other two domestic constituent groups come from the two opposite sides of China's political spectrum: the conservative nationalists versus the internationally minded reformers. China's collective financial statecraft with the BRICS engaging in global financial governance resonate with both of these groups, hence gaining support for the Chinese leadership. From the